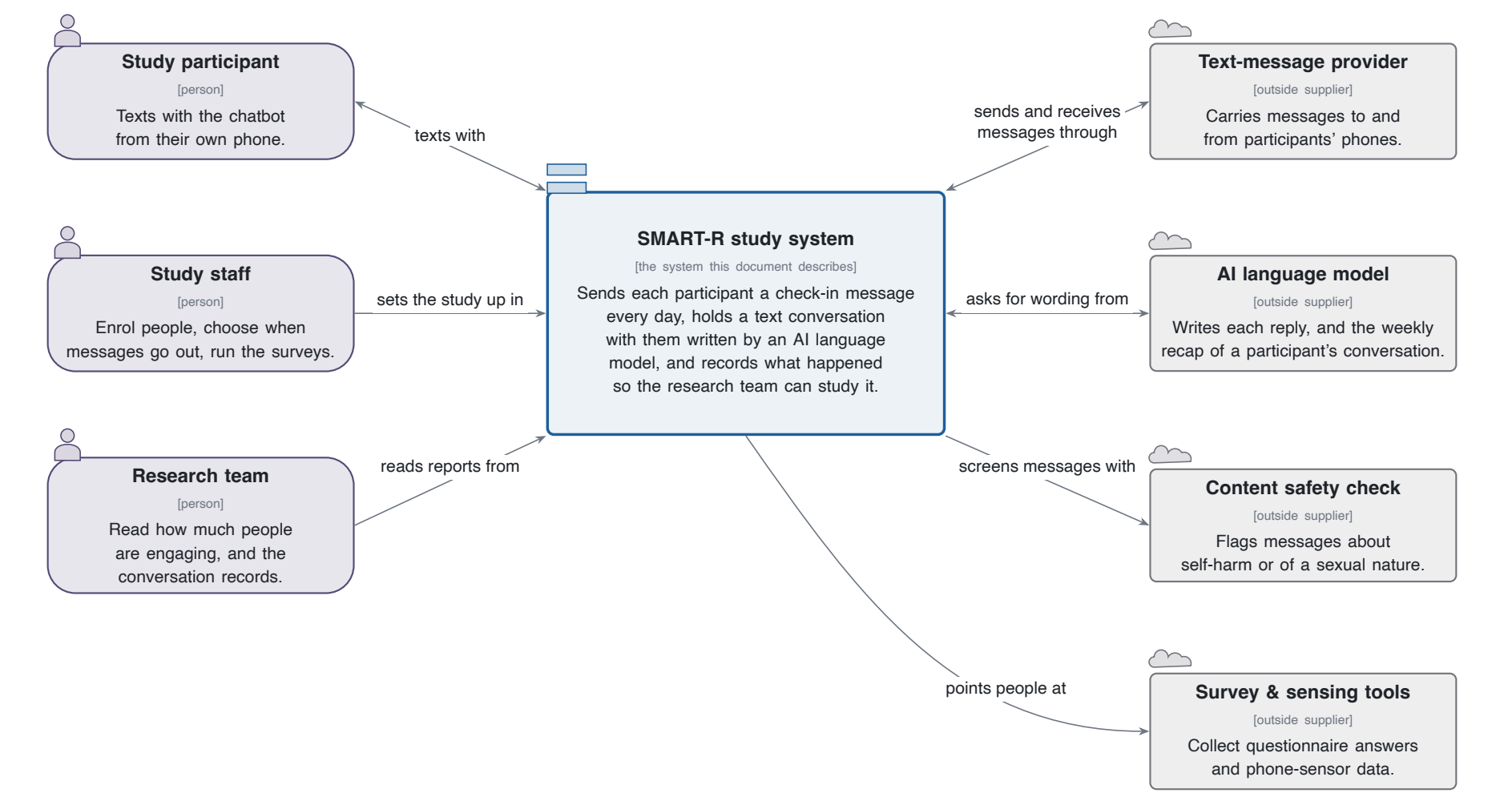


1 — System context

What the system is, who uses it, and what it relies on. No technical knowledge needed.

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The one thing to take away: the part of the system that knows who a participant is — their phone number and their enrolment — is deliberately kept apart from the part that talks to the AI language model. The AI side only ever sees an anonymous participant number. Page 2 shows that split.

How to read this page

a person

a running application

stored information

traffic director

outside supplier

Study & Messaging Service

Chatbot Service

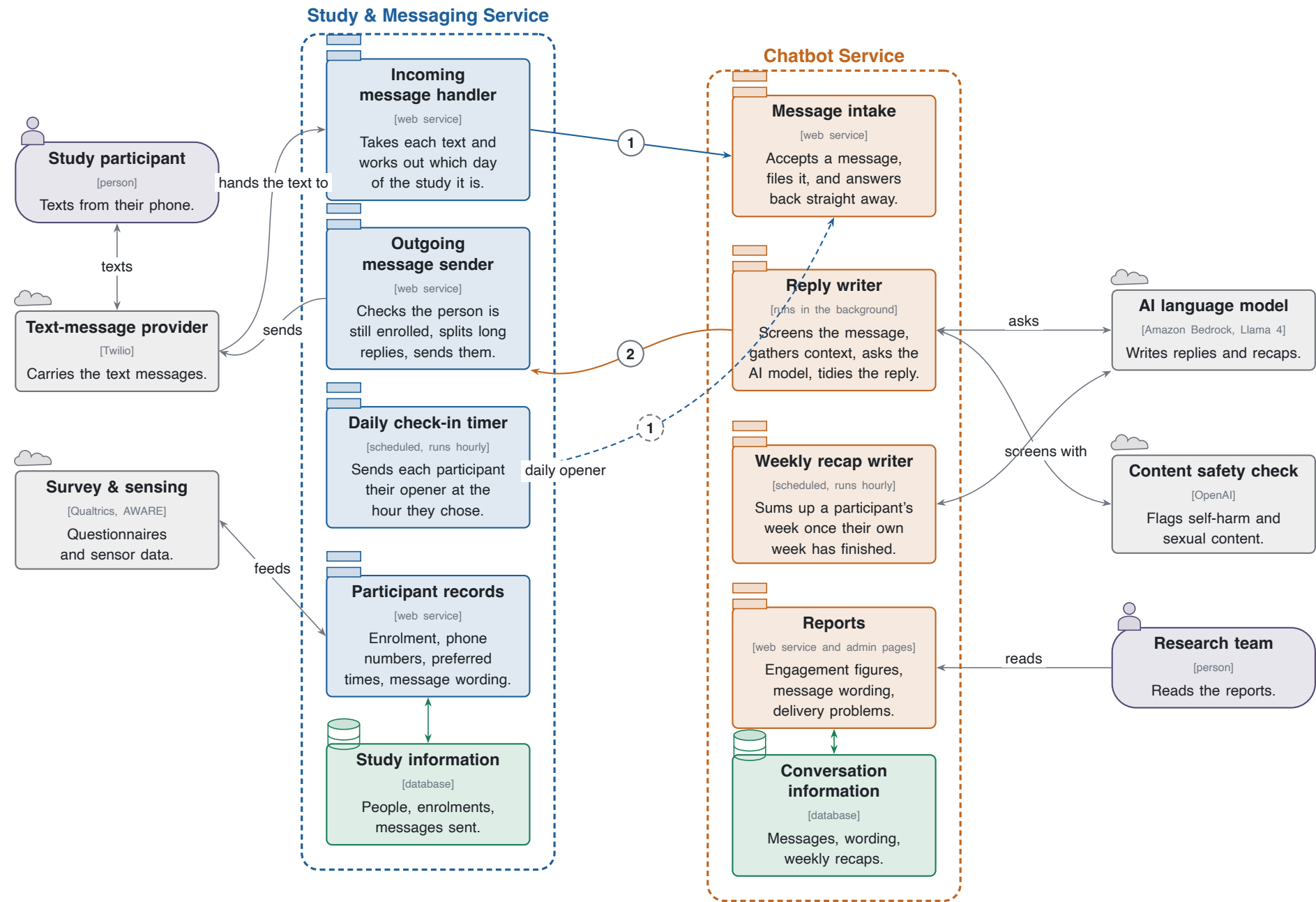
an arrow points at whatever is being asked to do something

[in brackets] the technology — for engineers; skip it if it means nothing to you

2 — The parts inside

The system is two separate services with two separate stores of information. They say only two things to each other.

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The only two things these services say to each other

- ① **“Here is a message.”** Study & Messaging → Chatbot. Carries the anonymous participant number, the text, which day of the study it is, and the participant's local time. A daily opener is marked as one, and is simply filed — the AI model is not asked for anything.
- ② **“Here is a reply. Please send it.”** Chatbot → Study & Messaging. Carries the participant number and the reply text.
- Neither service can read the other's stored information, and both requests need a password.

How to read this page



a person



a running application



stored information



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an arrow points at whatever is being asked to do something

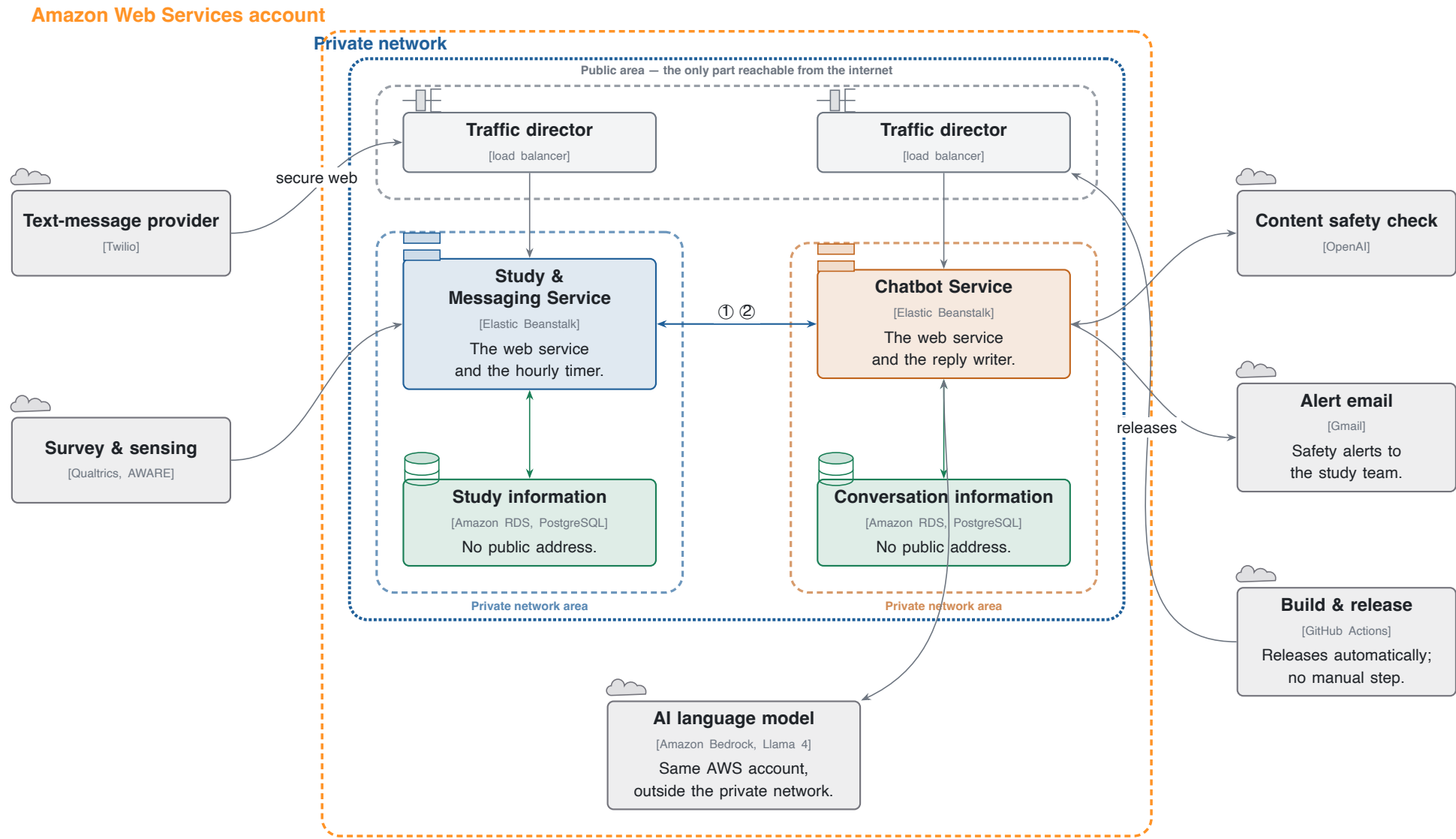


[in brackets] the technology — for engineers; skip it if it means nothing to you

3 — Where it runs

Both services run in a single Amazon Web Services account. Each keeps its own store of information, and neither store can be reached from the internet.

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Neither store of information has a public address, and there is no jump box. Reaching one means running a command on the server through AWS Systems Manager, then stepping into the running application. The Chatbot Service calls the AI model using the *shared* Elastic Beanstalk server identity rather than one of its own, so what this study spends on the AI model cannot be separated from what other projects in the account spend.

How to read this page

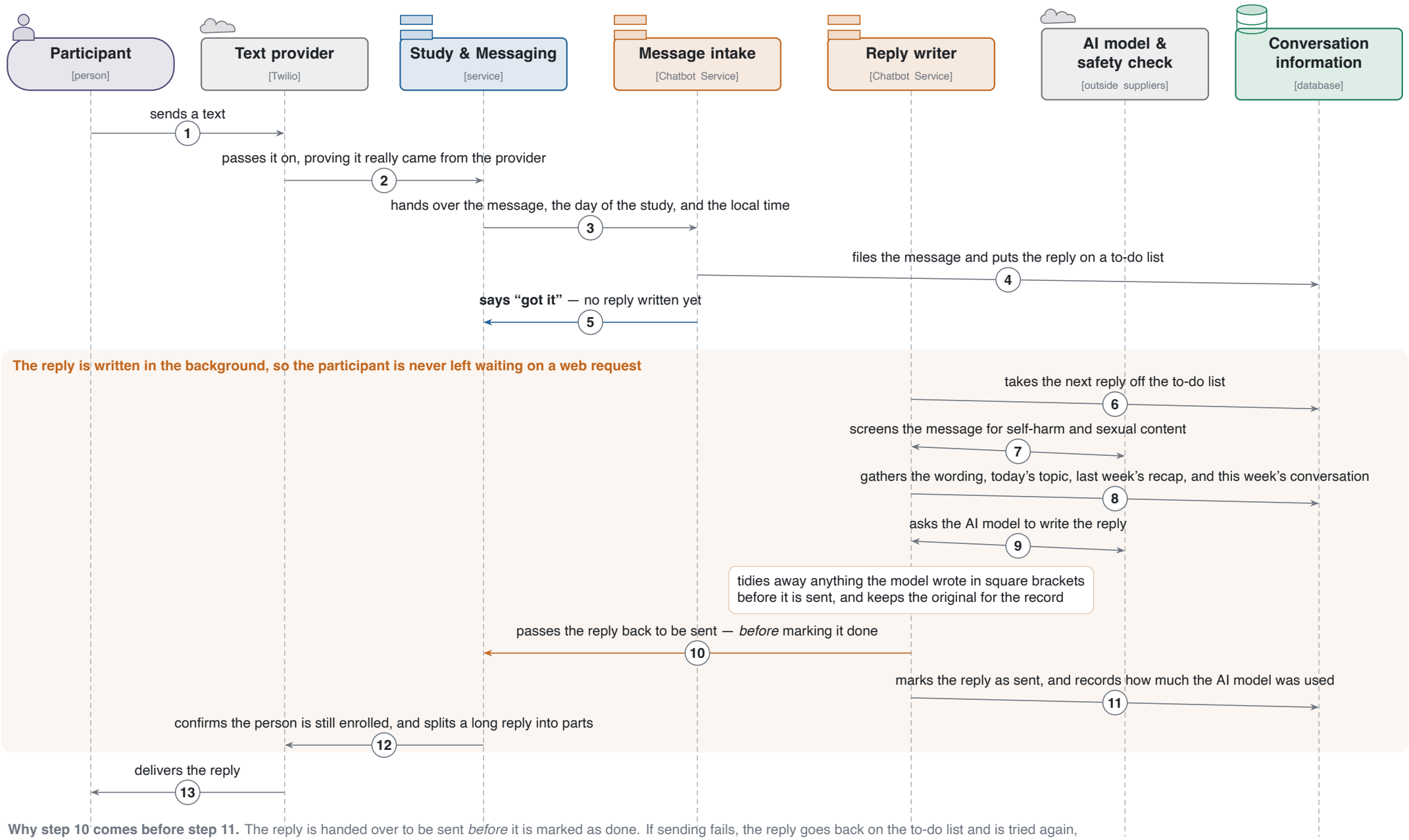
a person a running application stored information traffic director outside supplier

Study & Messaging Service Chatbot Service an arrow points at whatever is being asked to do something [in brackets] the technology — for engineers; skip it if it means nothing to you

4 — What happens to one message

A participant sends a text and gets a reply. Read top to bottom; each numbered step is one thing happening.

SMART-R text-messaging study • August 2026 • Scope: one incoming message. A daily opener is simply filed and skips steps 6–11.



How to read this page a person a running application stored information traffic director outside supplier
Study & Messaging Service Chatbot Service an arrow points at whatever is being asked to do something [in brackets] the technology — for engineers; skip it if it means nothing to you